

Problem Statement



Across numerous corners of the world, a myriad of students can decode text but still lack true comprehension, and this gap is one of the most persistent barriers in education. In the U.S., about 65% of 4th graders and nearly 70% of 8th graders, especially from underrepresented communities, are not proficient in reading comprehension, according to NAEP data. This leads to long-term academic inequality, especially for students without access to personalized support. In addition, teachers often manage 20–30+ students per class, making real-time reading intervention nearly impossible. Hence, we built Lumen AI to close this gap by turning reading into an interactive, adaptive experience with real-time comprehension checks and AI-driven explanations, aligned with UN SDG 4 (Quality Education) and SDG 10 (Reduced Inequalities).